

The Things I Can't Say in Person

Background

I am a boy from a well-educated family with high standards regarding discipline and education. From childhood, I was not raised like an ordinary child. Instead, I spent much of my time on the working side of my father's life - in labs, factories, and institutions. Because of this adult atmosphere, I saw and cope many aspects of adulthood early on by observing what older people do, face, and experience.

I was expected to live with a set of standards. In my family, there were clear expectations about the kind of people I should spend time with. I was expected to avoid friends who smoked, drank alcohol, were involved in gangs, theft, or irresponsible behaviour. I was also encouraged to stay away from people whose lifestyle or attitudes could negatively influence my discipline, education, or reputation. Because of these expectations, my choice of friends was always limited. While these rules helped me stay focused and avoid trouble, they also made it harder for me to form many friendships.

When I moved from my first place of living, I lost all my previous friends. After that, I only found one friend whom I truly trusted. At school, I never had a big circle of communication. I wasn't isolated, but I also never felt that I needed a large group of friends.

When I changed schools in the 7th grade due to a conflict with one of the boys, I slowly lost shared topics and motivation to stay connected with my friend. Later, while preparing to enter the lyceum, I became too focused on studying to build proper friendships. People often called me a "robot" — someone with no emotions who only focuses on completing tasks. As a result, I eventually lost contact with most of my schoolmates.

During my time in the lyceum, I met people whom I could actually become friends with, and I did form friendships. However, as time passed, many of them either left the country or entered closed institutions, which made maintaining those friendships very difficult.

As boys, it is not very common for us to keep chatting regularly if we are no longer in the same environment. Usually, we connect through shared activities — studying together, playing sports, working on something, or meeting in person. When that shared environment disappears, communication often becomes less frequent.

At university, there were not many people with whom I felt I could connect. The only other boy in the group was very different — he behaved strangely, rarely talked, and often ignored requests or comments from others. Because of that, I had to maintain good relationships with my female groupmates in order to avoid problems with group assignments, but this did not really give me a positive feeling. Over time, I developed a habit: as soon as classes ended, I would leave immediately.

During our internship in Korea, I tried to help Sitora. As a Muslim with limited experience traveling internationally, she faced many difficulties. I tried to support her, but my efforts never received the same response, and the situation did not become easier. Because of this, I slowly distanced myself from her group of communication.

When the second year of university started, I felt that I needed to gain the attention of a new student in order to increase my social role in the university. The new boy in our group suggested that we try joining startup projects. Since we shared similar interests, Anna, Shavkat, and I became quite close while working on the idea.

However, when the project did not succeed, we realized that we had little in common besides university. Later, Shavkat left due to family problems, and after that I mainly communicated with Anna only for study-related needs. In the end, I left with hardly any friends to have fun with. : (

To You ;)

I have never really experienced ignorance from the female side. I always knew that some girls were interested in me, and I even received a few direct confessions. But I never felt anything in return, so I ignored those situations.

What made you different was your attitude toward me. When you entered the university, you caught my attention. I saw you as someone I could possibly be with (friend). At first, I didn't want to make any move. I never rush into something before I understand the person better, and there was no need to hurry.

When we worked on the university marketing project, I saw how you always brought positive energy. You were always cheerful, the one who spread that mood to everyone around you. Your energy was shining, and I really liked that. Sometimes I tried to show my appreciation in small ways. If you remember the time when you felt bad because of a cold, I was the one who brought you a remedy.

As time went on, the team slowly started to lose interest in the project. Many of your ideas needed a team to make them happen, but I couldn't always involve others because everyone became busy with their own work. Because of that, I shifted more responsibility to you — because I trusted you. I believed that you could involve our circle of friends more freely and successfully. I saw that u not only u always tried to make what I asked, but also had respect to me that I really appreciate from u ;)

Over time, I began to feel that you might be the person I could build my life with. Because of that, I quietly tried to understand you better to see if you truly fit with me. What I realized was that you have many of the qualities I value - not only for me, but also the kind of person my parents would respect.

You look beautiful, but I am too shy to say that directly in person. You bring happiness to the people around you, and they feel it too. I didn't want to continue being the "robot" I used to be in school. In many ways, that is exactly what made me choose you. I didn't want to lose the chance and see you be taken by someone else.

So I made a plan to make you notice me as a partner. I originally planned that we would go to the mountains together, but when that didn't work out because others couldn't go, I decided to speak to you in person instead. I was really worried that you might refuse me. But when you agreed, my love, it meant a lot to me. From that moment on, there was no turning back for me. I knew this was not a game, but something serious that should lead to marriage. Hearing same from you truly made me very happy ;)

Since then, I have been trying my best not to give you a reason to regret your decision. Because our relationship is still complex, I am always trying to find ways that can bring us closer. I am not the most sociable person, and it is not always easy for me to start long or fun conversations. But I truly try my best so that you never feel bored with me.

What I wish from you is that sometimes you would start the conversation too, instead of always waiting for me to text first. When you message me or come to speak with me first, it makes me really happy. Sometimes I worry that I am forcing you to talk to me, and I never want to make you feel uncomfortable.

You might see me as someone who is always busy, but I will always find time for you. Seeing you is one of the best ways for me to relieve stress. I sometimes try to involve you in my work because it gives us the chance to spend more time together. I don't expect you to do everything perfectly - what I truly appreciate is that you try.

Whenever I ask what we should do first, think about the plans we promised to do together, please don't think about work. What matters most to me is spending time with you and making both of us happy.

I sometimes give you small gifts because I want you to know that I care about you and that my feelings for you have not disappeared. Since our situation does not always allow us to go to public places together, I try to create other things that we can do and enjoy together.

Also, please don't worry that these things will put me under financial pressure. Because we don't go out to many places, I have been able to save some money, and I planned this in advance. So there is no need to worry about that, my dear.

If you have read everything above, please tell me what you think. If you truly want to continue with me, write me a short message — at least three sentences — that shows me that you also believe we should be together. I won't text first this time; I will be waiting for your message. ;)

If you feel that I am not the right person for you, or if you have lost interest, you don't have to force yourself to reply. Silence will also be an answer, and I will understand it. In that case, I will stop bothering you.

Either way, the other half of the present is still yours. I will give it to you the next time I see you.

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Why am I confused?

You change a lot - and I'm okay with that. But the problem is that you don't want to accept yourself.

I always wait for your message. Sometimes I have nothing to say, and that's fine. But at night, when we have a wonderful conversation, I see that the waiting was worth it.

The problem comes after.

When you delete the chat the next day and say *"I don't know what happened to me"* - what I hear is: *"That wasn't me. Don't think I'm like that. Don't take what I wrote seriously."*

When you delete it to forget what happened, you're also deleting me. So the next day, I only see a version of you that focuses on what's physically comfortable - with no room for me as a boyfriend or a future husband. That scares me. Because if someone comes along who can offer you more material things, you'll have no reason to choose me instead.

If you truly don't want to be without me - you can delete a chat, you can reset, that's okay. But **never say "forget it" or "that wasn't me."** That's what breaks everything.

And if you keep forcing yourself to hide parts of who you are - just to appear strong and independent - there will be no space for me. Because "strong and independent" doesn't need a man. So I become nothing but a useless obstacle asking for your attention.

I don't want to be an obstacle. I want to be your choice.